Find an AI Opportunity in a Real Company

Assignment 1

> **Overview**
>
> For this assignment you will choose a company, study how it actually works, and then suggest a few AI features that could improve it. You can pick any company you want. The idea is to practise what a product manager does: understand a business properly, find the places where it struggles, and work out where AI can realistically help.

For each feature you suggest, note which type of AI it uses and what data it would need. We went through these categories in the session, so use the same set.

1. Please Do This Without AI

There is one condition for this assignment. Do it without using any AI tools. That means no ChatGPT, Claude, Perplexity, Gemini or anything similar, whether for the research, the analysis or the ideas.

The reason is simple. If you hand the thinking over to an AI, you will get a reasonable answer back, but you will not have built the skill this assignment is meant to build. I would much rather see your own rough thinking than a polished answer from a tool.

You can use the company's own website and app, articles and posts you read yourself, and conversations with people who know the business. You are also welcome to study an AI company such as Claude or Perplexity. Just do not use AI to study it.

2. Step 1: Pick a Company

Choose any company you like. It can be large or small, Indian or global, B2B or B2C. A few to get you started:

- AI products: Claude (Anthropic), Perplexity, OpenAI
- Apps you use: Zomato, Swiggy, Airbnb, Spotify, Netflix
- A bank, a retailer, or a local business you know well

Try to pick something you can actually look at and understand, not just a brand you admire.

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3. Step 2: Understand the Business First

Before you think about AI at all, get clear on how the company works. Answer these in your own words:

- What does the company do, and who pays for it?
- How does it make money?
- What are the main things it has to get right to run well?
- Where do things go wrong, or get slow, expensive, or frustrating?
- What information or data does the business collect along the way?

If your understanding of the business is thin, your AI ideas will be thin too. Spend real time here.

4. Step 3: Suggest AI Features

Now suggest three to five AI features. Each one should fix a problem you found in Step 2, not just sound impressive. Fill in the table below, one row per feature. For each feature, also name the metrics it would move, since that is what you will be measured on as a PM.

As a reminder, the categories are Generative AI (DL), Prediction AI (ML), Image AI (Computer Vision), Voice AI (Speech and Audio), Recommendation AI (Next Best Action or Product), and Text Analysis AI (Sentiment, Insights). Some features could fit more than one. Pick the closest.

Feature	Problem it solves	Type of AI	Data needed	What it improves	Metrics it will impact
Assistant that drafts support replies from past tickets	Support is slow during busy hours	Generative AI (DL)	Old support tickets and help articles	Faster support replies	First-response time, CSAT (example)

5. What and Where to Submit

Write it up in one or two pages, or four to six slides, whichever you prefer. Include your notes from Step 2, the completed table, and a short paragraph on which feature you would build first and why.

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Deadline: upload your assignment to the LMS during the week, by 20th August (Thursday).

Please know that this activity is a foundation for a bigger activity in the future, where you will tweet your AI product suggestions directly to CEOs who respond on X.

6. How It Will Be Evaluated

Top 3 submissions will be recognized in the next session. Feedback will be provided for all submissions.

What we look at	Marks
How well you understand the business	25
How real the problems you spotted are	20
Whether the AI features actually fit those problems	25
Correct type of AI and sensible data for each feature	20
Your own original thinking	10

> **Key Insight**
>
> Good luck. Start from the business, and the AI ideas will follow.

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